If we don't get to join the eternal multiverse party ourselves, at least our looming death can be good for physics. Neil Turok points out that the prospect of an end of time in the future, combined with the existence of our cosmic horizon, places hard boundaries on the universe, and thus helpful limits to the problem of understanding it all. A light wave traveling across a limited, expanding, accelerating universe can undergo only so many oscillations, even into the infinite future. "We live, effectively, in a box, okay? Which is finite. And if that's true, I think it's to be welcomed because we could understand it. The problem of understanding the universe just got a whole lot easier because it's finite," he says. "Finite to the past, finite in space because of the horizon, finite to the future because everything will only oscillate a finite number of times. Wow! I mean, that's understandable. I'm an optimist by nature, but I think the world is our oyster."

If the universe is going to end, one way or another, I concede that we may as well make our peace with it. Pedro Ferreira is way ahead of me on that one. "I think it's great," he says. "It's so simple and so clean.

"I've never understood why people get so depressed about the end, the death of the Sun and all," he continues. "I just like the serenity of it."

"So it doesn't bother you that we ultimately have no legacy in the universe?" I ask him.

"No, not at all," he says. "I very much like our blip-ness … It's always appealed to me," he continues. "It's the transience of these things. It's the doing. It's the process. It's the journey. Who cares where you get to, right?"

I admit it, I still care. I'm trying not to get hung up on it, on the ending, the last page, the end of this great experiment of existence. *It's the journey*, I repeat to myself. It's the journey.

There is perhaps some solace in the fact that whatever happens, it's not our fault. Renée Hložek considers this a definite plus.

"I love the fact that my work, even if I do it 100 percent perfectly and I'm an incredible scientist, it changes nothing about the fate of the universe," she says. "All we are trying to do is understand it. And even if you do understand it, we can do nothing to change it. I think that's freeing rather than scary."

To Hložek, the Heat Death isn't depressing, or boring. She calls it "cold and beautiful." "It's like the universe just sorts itself out," she says.

"What I hope that people get out of your book is that it's possible for the human mind to use observations of light—and/or gravitational waves, but